SECTION 2

Getting Started with eBPLS

This section shows how to open the Online Business Permit and Licensing System (eBPLS), sign in, and create a new account.

2.1 Opening eBPLS

1. From the OAS home page (oas.lguapp.com), scroll to **LGU Online Applications**.
2. Click the **New/Register Business Permit** card. The card is highlighted when you point to it.

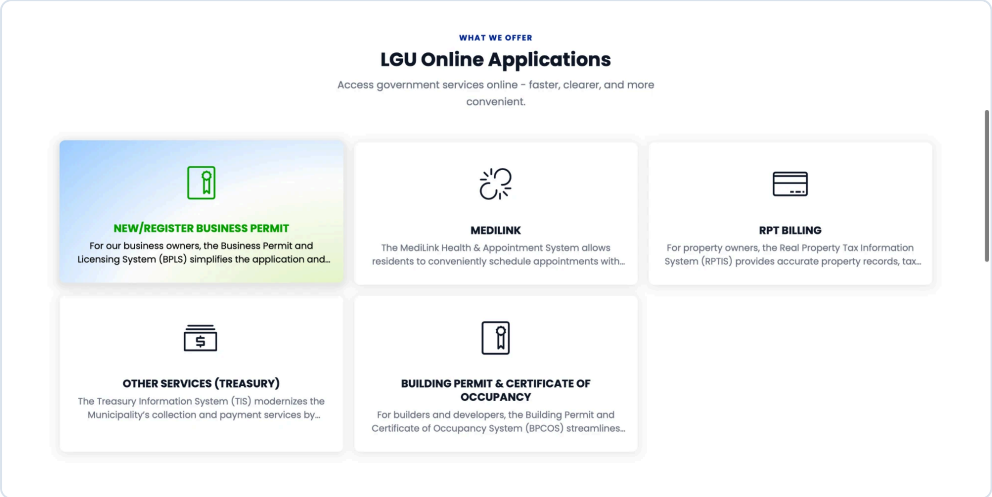


Figure 2.1. Click the New/Register Business Permit card.

The eBPLS landing page opens. It introduces the Online Business Permit and Licensing System and highlights its main features: online application and submission, automated processing, clearance verification, real-time status updates and digital permit issuance.

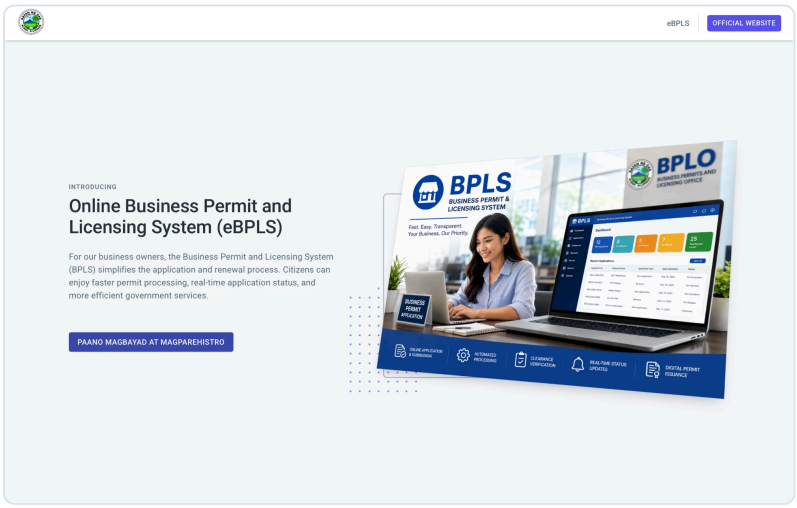


Figure 2.2. The eBPLS landing page.

At the top right of the landing page you will see two buttons:

- **eBPLS:** opens the sign-in page.
- **Official Website:** returns to the OAS website.

Click **eBPLS** to go to the sign-in page.

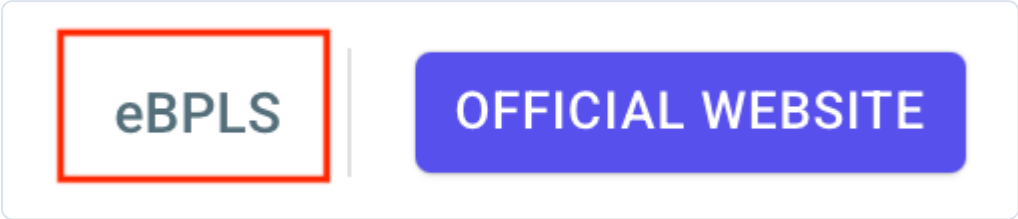


Figure 2.3. Click eBPLS (highlighted) at the top right to sign in.

2.2 Signing in

1. On the **Sign in** page, enter your **Email Address**.
2. Enter your **Password**.
3. Click **Log In**.

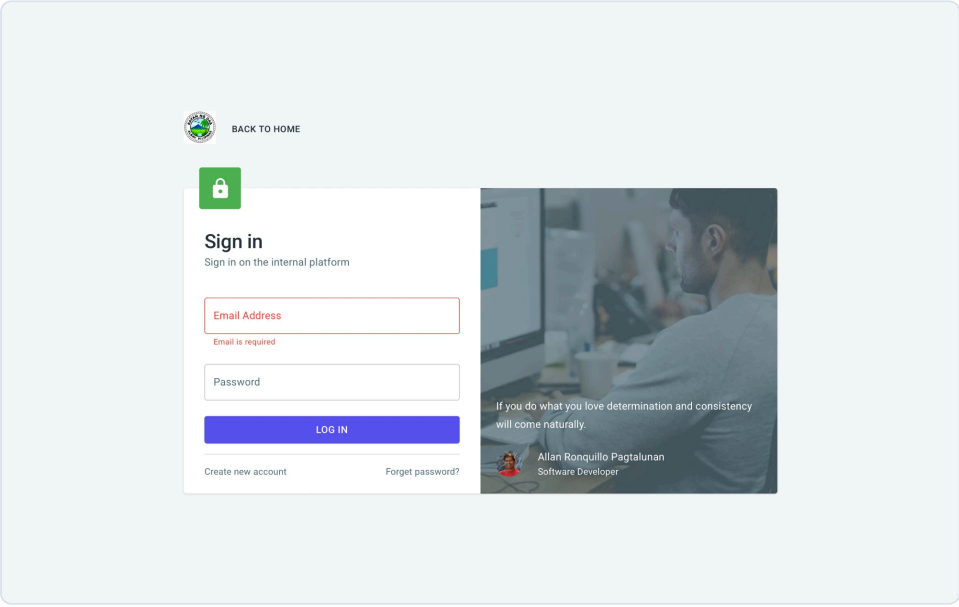


Figure 2.4. The Sign in page.

> **ERROR:** if a field is left empty, the system shows a red message under it (for example, *Email is required*). Fill in the field and try again.

If the email or password is wrong, a red message appears below the **Log In** button. The message depends on which entry is wrong.

If the password is wrong

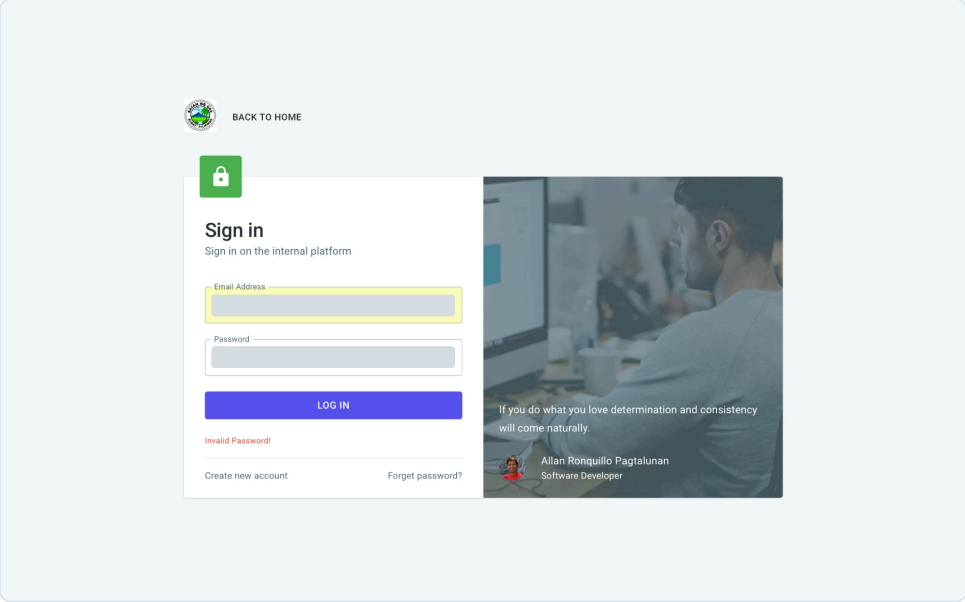


Figure 2.5. The Sign in page when the email is correct but the password is wrong.

If the email is not registered

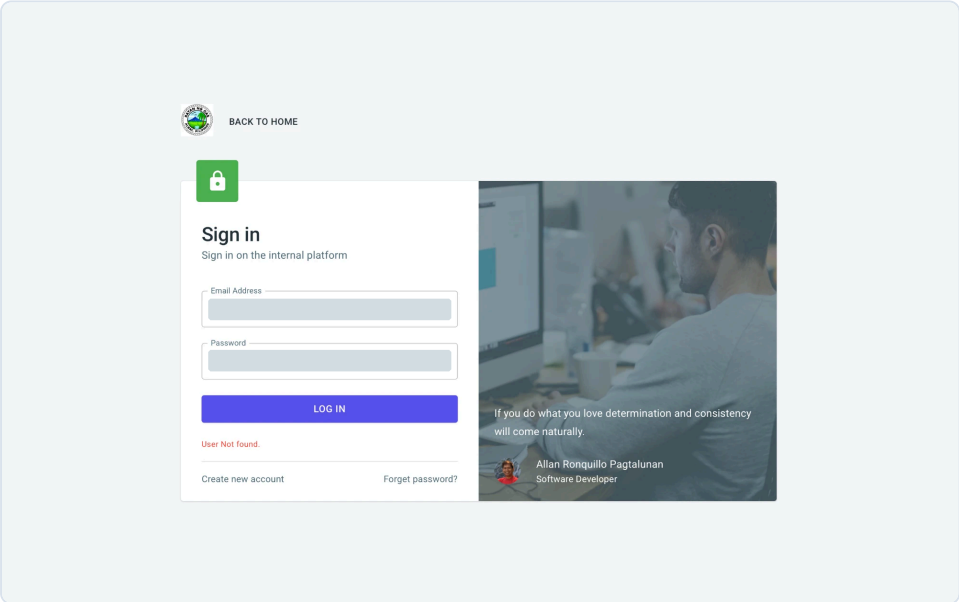


Figure 2.6. The Sign in page when no account exists for the email.

Summary of the messages:

Message	What it means
User Not found.	No account exists for the email you typed. Check the spelling or create an account.
Invalid Password!	The password does not match the account. Retype it, or use **Forget password?**

Other options on the Sign in page:

Option	Use it to
Create new account	Register as a new user (see Section 2.3).
Forget password?	Reset a forgotten password (see Section 2.5).
Back to Home	Return to the OAS website.

2.3 Creating an account

New users must create an account before applying. From the Sign in page, click **Create new account** to open the **Sign up** form.

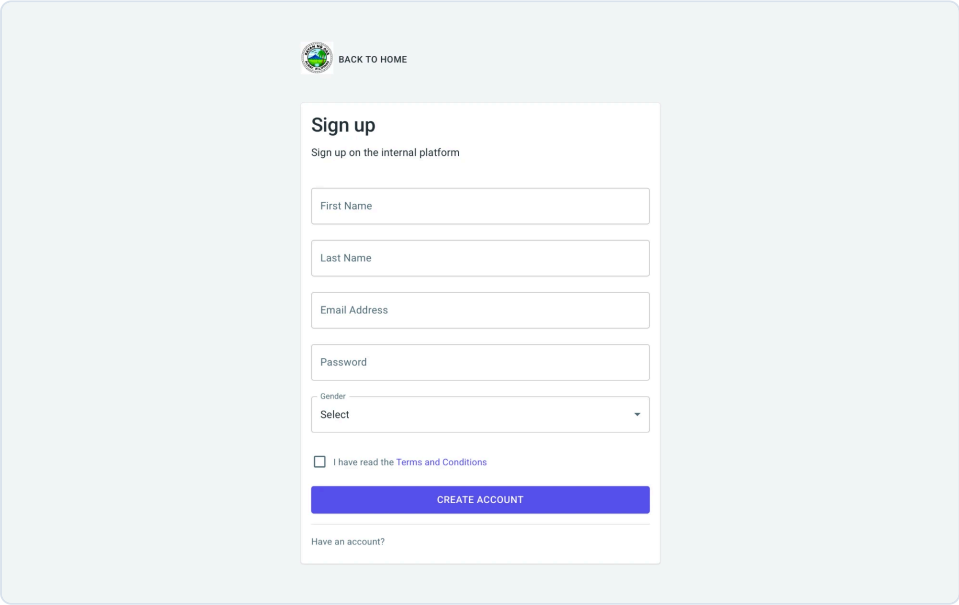


Figure 2.7. The Sign up form.

1. Enter your **First Name** and **Last Name**.
2. Enter a valid **Email Address**. A verification code will be sent to this address, so use an email you can open right now.

3. Enter a **Password** of at least 7 characters.
4. Choose your **Gender** (Male or Female).
5. Tick **I have read the Terms and Conditions**. You can click the *Terms and Conditions* link to read them first. The box must be ticked to continue.
6. Click **Create Account**.

> All fields are required. After you click **Create Account**, a verification code is sent to your email. Continue with the verification steps in Section 2.4.

If the email is already registered

If an account already exists for the email you entered, a red message appears at the lower left when you click **Create Account**, and no code is sent.

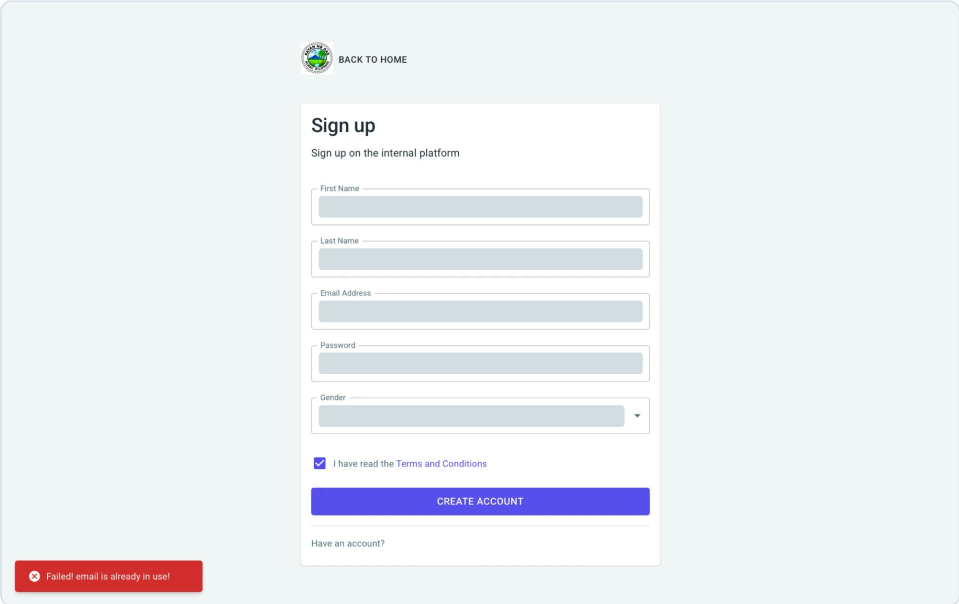


Figure 2.8. The message shown when the email is already in use.

> **ERROR:** *Failed! email is already in use!* Use a different email address, or go to the Sign in page and sign in with the existing account. If you forgot the password, use **Forget password?**

Already registered? Click **Have an account?** at the bottom of the form to go back to the Sign in page.

2.4 Verifying your email

After you click **Create Account**, the form is replaced by a verification screen and a green message appears at the lower left: *Check your email and copy the code!*

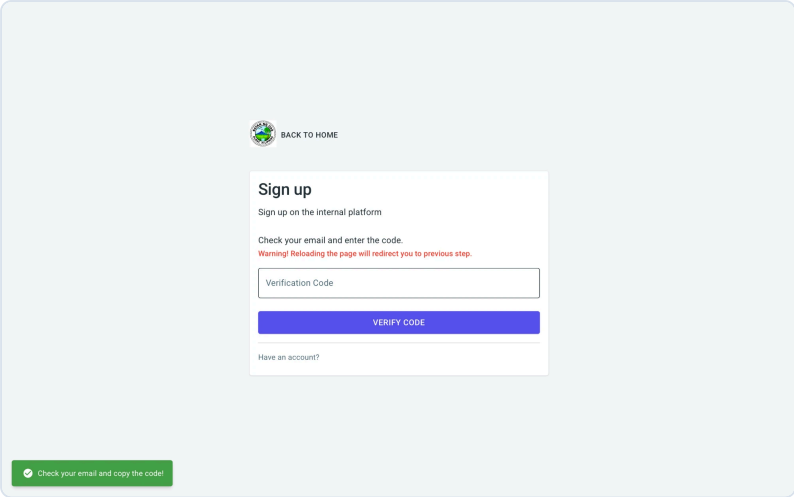


Figure 2.9. The verification screen after clicking Create Account.

> **WARNING:** do not reload or refresh this page. Reloading sends you back to the previous step (the Sign up form) and you will need to start again.

1. Open the email address you registered with. You will receive an email titled **eBPLS OAS Verification Code**. If you do not see it, check your Spam or Junk folder.
2. Find the 6-digit code in the email.

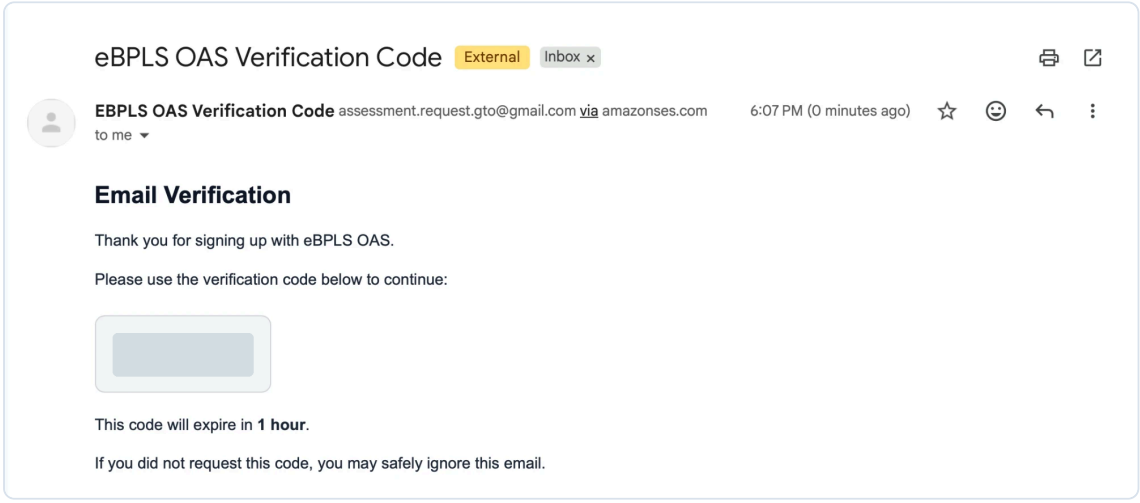


Figure 2.10. The verification email. The code is shown in the box.

The email also says that **the code expires in 1 hour**. If you did not request the code, you can ignore the email.

3. Go back to the verification screen and type the code into the **Verification Code** field.
4. Click **Verify Code**.

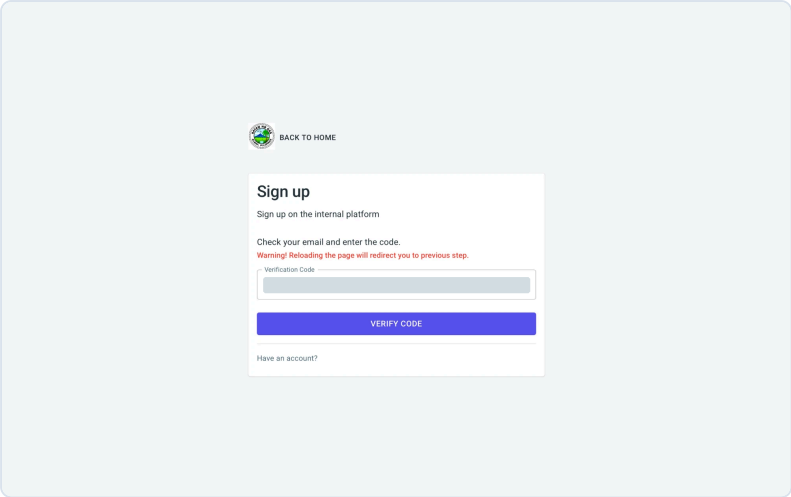


Figure 2.11. Enter the code and click Verify Code.

If the code is correct, you are taken to the Sign in page and a green message appears at the lower left: **Registration completed!** Your account is ready. Enter your email and password to sign in (see Section 2.2).

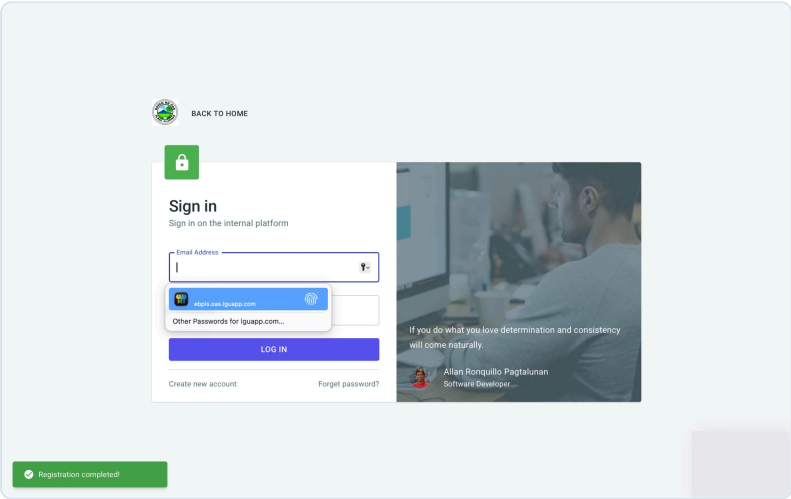


Figure 2.12. The Sign in page with the "Registration completed!" message.

If the code is wrong

If the code you enter is incorrect, an error message appears at the lower left of the screen, as shown below. You stay on the verification screen and can try again.

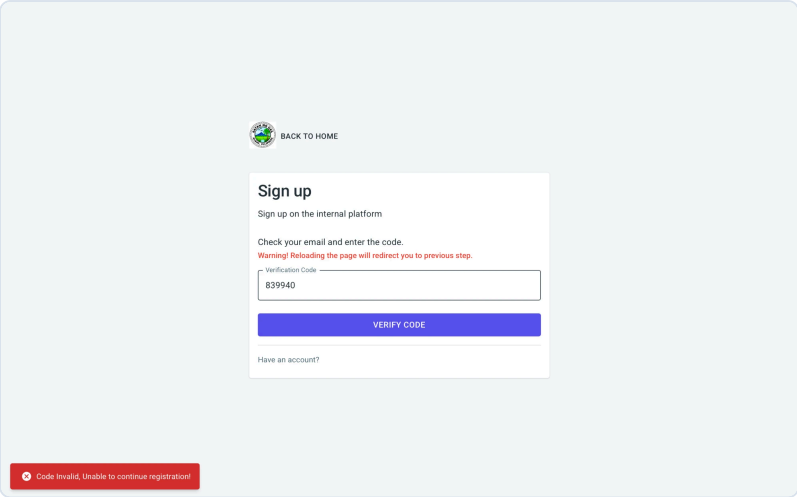


Figure 2.13. A wrong code shows a red message at the lower left.

ERROR: *Code Invalid, Unable to continue registration!* The code you entered does not match. Check the code in the email, retype it carefully and click **Verify Code** again. Do not reload the page.

Other messages you may see while registering

Message	What it means and what to do
Check your email and copy the code! (green)	The code was sent. Open your email and continue with the steps above.
Failed! email is already in use! (red)	An account already exists for this email. Go back to the Sign in page and sign in, or use **Forget password?** if you cannot remember the password.
Code is not sent. Check your internet connection. (red)	The system could not send the email. Check your connection and click **Create Account** again.
Must be a valid email / *First name is required* / *Last name is required* / *Gender is required*	A Sign up field is empty or incorrect. The message appears under the field. Correct it and try again.
Registration completed! (green)	Your account is ready. Sign in.

2.5 Forgot your password

If you cannot remember your password, you can set a new one using a link sent to your email.

Step 1. Request a recovery link

1. On the Sign in page, click **Forget password?**

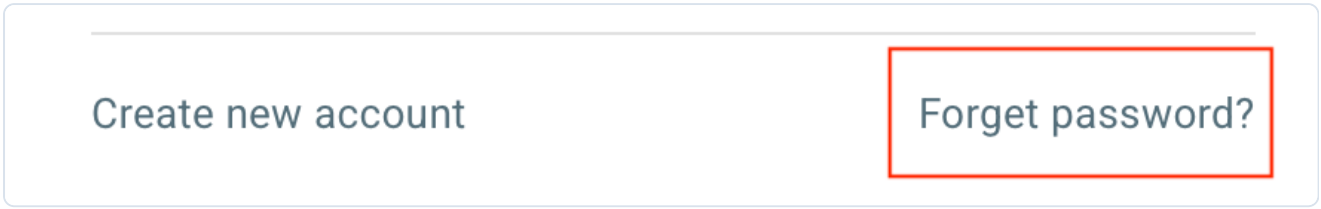


Figure 2.14. Click Forget password? (highlighted) on the Sign in page.

2. On the **Recovery** page, enter the **Email** you registered with.
3. Click **Recover Password**.

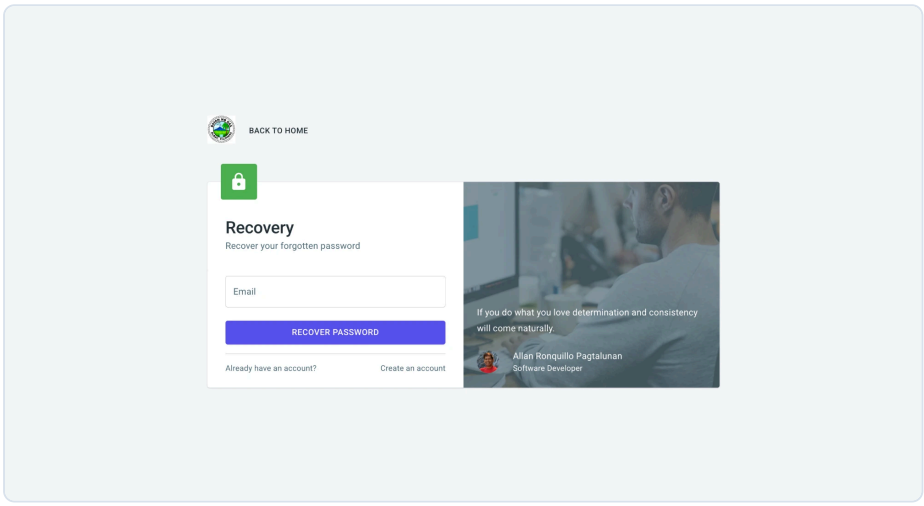


Figure 2.15. The Recovery page.

You are taken back to the Sign in page and a green message appears at the lower left: **Recovery link successfully sent to your email.**

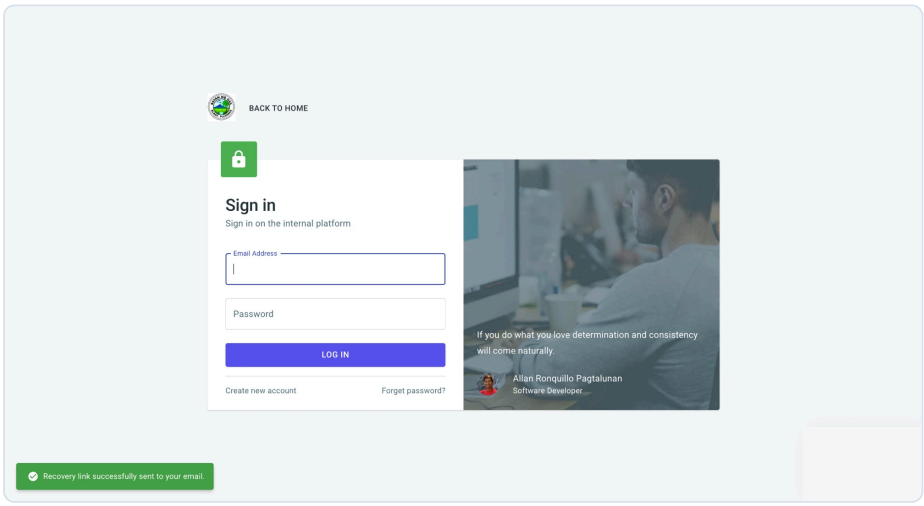


Figure 2.16. The Sign in page with the "Recovery link successfully sent to your email." message.

Step 2. Open the link in your email

Open the email titled **EBPLs Password Reset**. If you do not see it, check your Spam or Junk folder. Click the **Reset Password** button. If the button does not work, copy the link shown in the email and paste it into your browser.

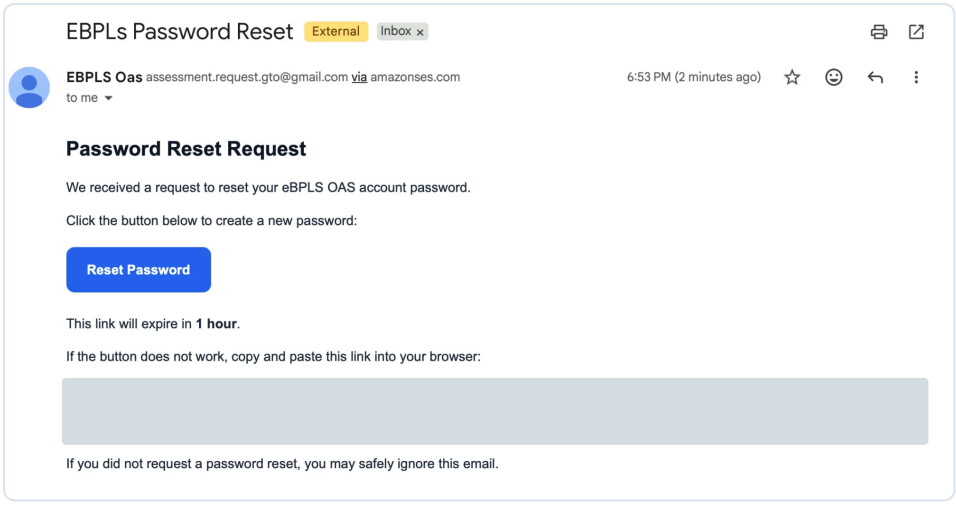


Figure 2.17. The password reset email. The full link is hidden in this figure.

> **WARNING:** the link expires in **1 hour**. If you did not ask for a password reset, ignore the email and your password stays the same. Do not share the link with anyone.

Step 3. Enter a new password

The link opens the **Reset Password** page in your browser.

1. Enter your new **Password** (at least 7 characters).
2. Enter it again in **Confirm Password**.
3. Click **Reset Password**.

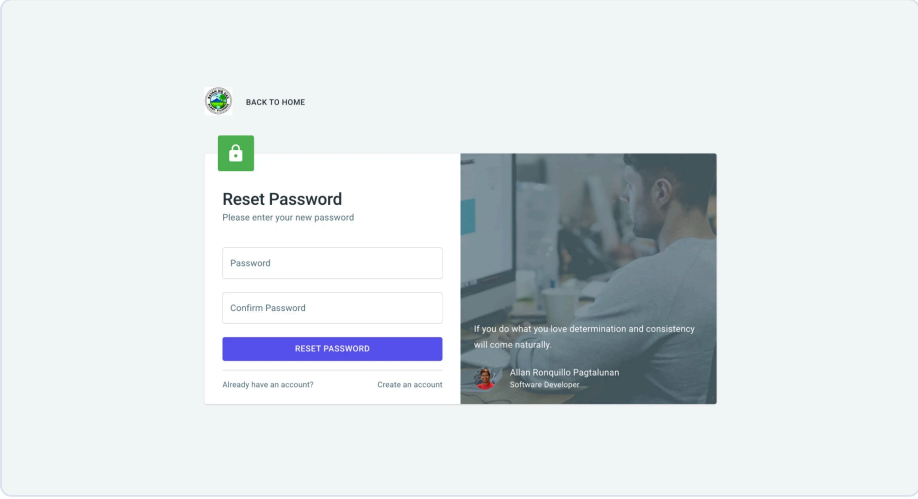


Figure 2.18. The Reset Password page.

After the password is reset, you are returned to the Sign in page. Sign in with your email and the new password.

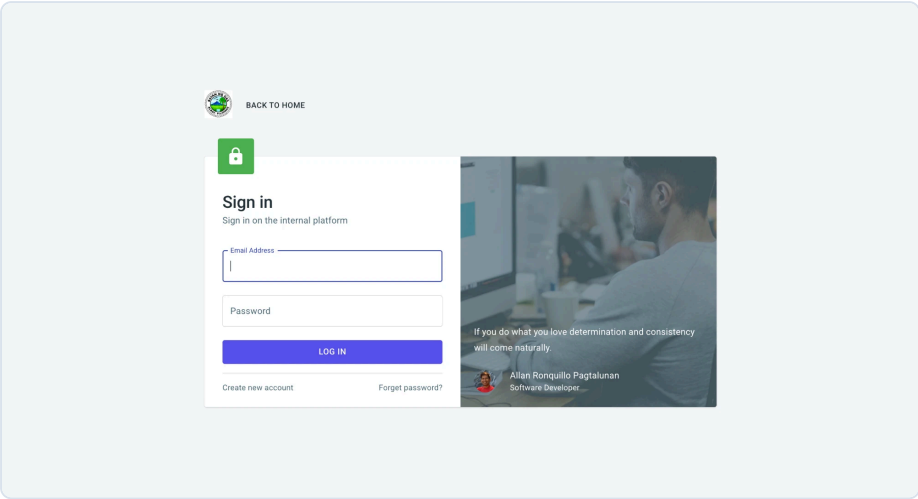


Figure 2.19. You are redirected to the Sign in page after resetting your password.

Messages you may see

Message	What it means and what to do
Email address is required	The Email field on the Recovery page is empty. Enter your email.
Email address not found. (red)	No account exists for that email. Check the spelling, or create an account.
Recovery link successfully sent to your email. (green)	The link was sent. Open your email.
Must be at least 7 characters	The new password is too short. Use 7 or more characters.
Passwords must match	Password and Confirm Password are different. Retype both.
Password Successfully Reset (green)	Your password was changed. Sign in with the new password.

> **ERROR:** if the reset link has expired or is no longer valid, the Reset Password page does not open. Go back to the Sign in page and request a new recovery link (Step 1).

2.6 After you sign in

After a successful sign in, eBPLS opens the **Business Holdings** page. This is where the applicant's businesses are listed and managed.

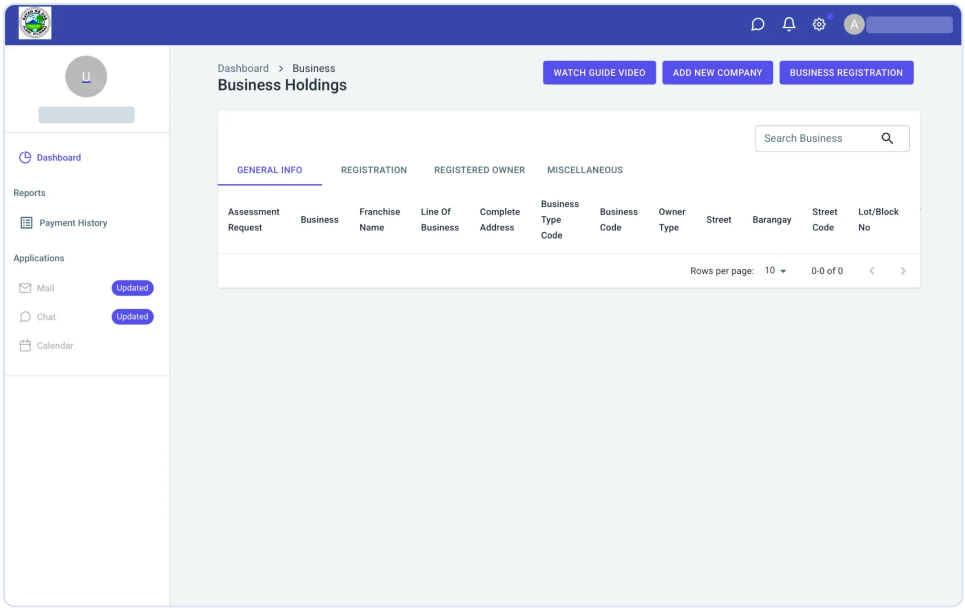


Figure 2.20. The Business Holdings page of a new account with no business holding record yet.

> **No business holding record yet.** When an account has no business holding record, the Business Holdings page appears as shown in the figure above: the table lists only its column headings, and the page count at the bottom reads **0-0 of 0**. This is the normal appearance of a newly created account and does not indicate an error. Business holding records appear in this table once a business has been added to, or linked with, the account.

Section 3 describes this page and its menus in detail, and explains how to add or link a business and file a permit request.